

Monday, 1 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light rain

23° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

17° 14°

MANCHESTER

Rain

18° 14°

GLASGOW

Light rain

18° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

The Home Office plans to use artificial intelligence from next year to help estimate the age of asylum seekers.

This new tool aims to identify adult migrants who might be misrepresenting their age. It's part of efforts to improve the asylum process.

POLITICS · UK

2

AI versions of famous historical figures like Winston Churchill and Frida Kahlo appeared on Question Time this week.

The programme used these digital doppelgangers to kick off a debate about the growing concerns surrounding artificial intelligence. It was certainly an unusual start to the show.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

3

A rare type of toad found in Scotland is struggling to recover because its habitat waters are becoming too salty.

A new study of Scotland's only natterjack toad colonies found that high salt levels are impacting their size and survival rates. It's a real challenge for conservation efforts.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1

Russell T Davies, the creative force behind the upcoming new drama 'Tip Toe', has shared his hopes for television.

He told BBC News he wishes TV could truly change the world, during exclusive behind-the-scenes access on set. Keep an eye out for 'Tip Toe' when it arrives.

TV · UPCOMING

2

Following Radio 1's Big Weekend, music fans are now looking ahead to what's next for the headline acts.

Olivia Dean, Zara Larsson, and Fatboy Slim were among those topping the bill, and their performances have set the stage for their upcoming projects and tours. It will be interesting to see what they do next.

MUSIC · UPCOMING

3

Manchester City footballer Ruben Dias has spoken out, clarifying his future approach to public speculation about his private life.

He usually keeps silent on rumours, but felt compelled to address recent reports. It appears he's keen to draw a line under the gossip and move forward.

CELEBRITY · FUTURE

On the schedule

- 1 Arsenal got off to a flying start in the Champions League final against Paris Saint-Germain.**
Kai Havertz found the net early on, giving the Gunners a crucial lead in Budapest. Fans will be hoping they can maintain that momentum.
FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Manchester United midfielder Manuel Ugarte has been named in Uruguay's squad for the upcoming World Cup.**
This is great news for the young United star, though veteran striker Luis Suarez was a notable omission. The squad will now be preparing for the tournament.
FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Brighton's manager Dario Vidosic is hoping for a special victory in Sunday's Women's FA Cup final.**
He's aiming to honour his late father when his team takes on Manchester City. It's bound to be an emotional occasion for him and the team.
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 2 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 3 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.
- 4 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 5 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 6 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 7 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 44% of us have done THIS while waiting for a kettle to boil. What?
ANSWER: WANDERED OFF AND FORGOTTEN ABOUT IT ENTIRELY.

Q 75% of us check THIS more than ten times a day. What?
ANSWER: THE WEATHER APP.

TALK TOPIC

- **Apparently 1 in 5 of us have a 'comfort show' we've watched more than 10 times.**
Talk-back: what's yours? Friends? Gavin and Stacey? Bake Off? Reveal yourself.
- **If you could un-invent ONE thing from modern life, what would it be?**
Talk-back: not phones. Pick something specific. Self-checkouts? Wireless earbuds that always die? The Selfridges Christmas advert?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Travel.** A small Welsh railway station — Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlantysiliogogoch — sells more platform-ticket souvenirs than any other UK station.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Norfolk B&B has started offering a 'no chit-chat' room for guests who want to skip breakfast small talk, marked with a polite door card and a £10 surcharge.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.01 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.01 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A blue whale's tongue alone weighs as much as an elephant.
- Octopuses can taste with their suckers.
- Wales has more castles per square mile than any other country in the world.
- Bananas grow upside down.
- Your nose can detect over a trillion different scents.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way.
- A snail can sleep for three years at a time.

On this day

Day 152 of the year, 213 days left in 2026. Today Children's Day (International), and its related observances: The Day of Protection of Children Rights (Armenia); Children's Day (International), and its related observances: Mothers' and Children's Day (Mongolia); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfonso Navarrete; Christian feast day: Annibale Maria di Francia. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Robert Powell, English actor
- 1996 — Tom Holland, English actor
- 1937 — Morgan Freeman, American actor and producer
- 1945 — Linda Scott, American singer
- 1947 — Jonathan Pryce, Welsh actor and singer
- 1950 — Charlene, American singer-songwriter
- 1981 — Amy Schumer, American comedian and actress
- 1948 — Powers Boothe, American actor (died 2017)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — The first black-led government of Rhodesia (now Zimbabwe) in 90 years takes power.
- 1962 — Adolf Eichmann, former SS officer in Nazi Germany, is hanged in Israel for having committed crimes against humanity, war crimes, and other offenses.
- 1976 — Aeroflot Flight 418 crashes in Bioko, Equatorial Guinea, killing 46.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2001 — Dolphinarium discotheque massacre: A Hamas suicide bomber kills 21 at a disco in Tel Aviv.
- 1951 — Washington State Ferries, the largest ferry system in the United States, begins operation under state ownership after a buyout of the Puget Sound Navigation Company.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1990 — Cold War: George H. W. Bush and Mikhail Gorbachev sign a treaty to end chemical weapon production.
- 2015 — A ship carrying 458 people capsizes in the Yangtze river in China's Hubei province, killing 442 people.

- 1976 — Aeroflot Flight 418 crashes in Bioko, Equatorial Guinea, killing 46.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 153 of the year, 212 days left in 2026. Today Children's Day (North Korea); Christian feast day: Ahudemme (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Alexander (martyr); Christian feast day: Elmo. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1988 — Awkwafina, American actress, rapper, and comedian
- 1980 — Richard Skuse, English rugby player
- 1959 — Lydia Lunch, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actress
- 1980 — Fabrizio Moretti, Brazilian-American drummer
- 1976 — Tim Rice-Oxley, English singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 1955 — Dana Carvey, American comedian and actor
- 1978 — Dominic Cooper, English actor
- 1972 — Wayne Brady, American actor, comedian, game show host, and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1966 — Surveyor program: Surveyor 1 lands in Oceanus Procellarum on the Moon, becoming the first U.S. spacecraft to soft-land on another world.
- 1964 — The Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) is formed.
- 1983 — After an emergency landing because of an in-flight fire, twenty-three passengers aboard Air Canada Flight 797 are killed when a flashover occurs as the plane's doors open. Because of this incident, numerous new safety regulations are put in place.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2023 — A collision between two passenger trains and a parked freight train near the city of Balasor, Odisha in eastern India, results in 296 deaths and more than 1,200 people injured.
- 1997 — In Denver, Timothy McVeigh is convicted on 15 counts of murder and conspiracy for his role in the 1995 bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building in Oklahoma City, in which 168 people died. He was executed four years later.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)